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‘It sends a message that you will be caught.’

THADDEUS JOHNSON, a senior fellow at the Council on Criminal Justice, on the importance of solving homicides

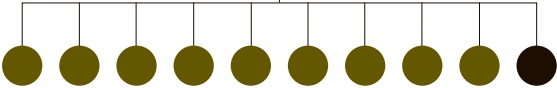
A loss, left unanswered



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Judy Rodriguez’s son, Jahzier Les Porter, was killed two years ago. She’s still waiting for an arrest. “I want to rest easy knowing that we caught the people who did this,” Rodriguez said. “I want them to do their damn job.”

82% of cases under Michael Morrissey are cleared. These 10 are unsolved.



In Morrissey’s jurisdiction from 2015 to 2024, all 10 unsolved homicides involve shootings that occurred outdoors.

In all but one case, the victims were Black or Latino males.

Norfolk district attorney has lowest homicide clearance among peers

By Laura Crimaldi

GLOBE STAFF

Judy Rodriguez keeps photographs, candles, and flowers at the spot outside her home in Braintree where her 16-year-old son and another teenager were shot to death. Two years after that night, she’s still waiting for answers.

“I want them to get to the bottom of this,” Rodriguez said. “I want to rest easy knowing that we caught the people who did this. I want them to do their damn job.”

The murders of her son, Jahzier Les Porter, and Jayden Santos-Andrade, 19, are among 10 unsolved killings under investigation by the State Police unit attached to the office of Norfolk District Attorney Michael W. Morrissey — the same squad in the two controversial investigations of Karen Read and Sandra Birchmore.

And while Morrissey’s office has a high rate of resolving homicide cases compared to the national average, it trails its State Police peers in Massachusetts with the lowest clearance rate of murders among the state’s 11 district attorneys: investigators in Norfolk County solved 82 percent of 57 homicides, a Boston Globe review of cases between 2015 and 2024 found.

In Massachusetts, homicide investigations in all but four cities are handled by State Police units attached to the local district attorney, an elected position.

Homicide clearance rates at the other State Police squads ranged from 88 percent at the Essex and Plym-

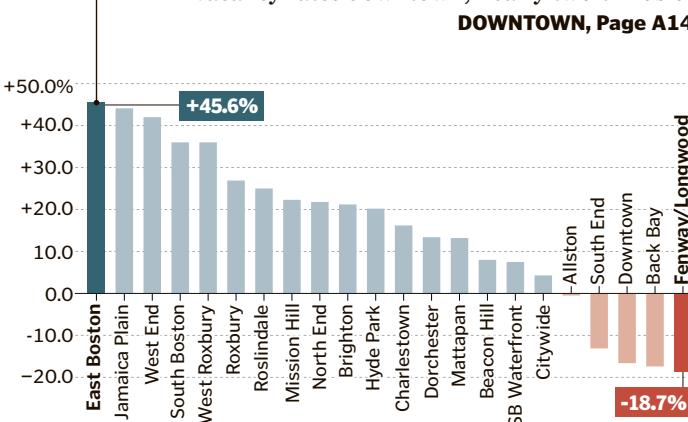
MURDERS, Page A15

Downtown cedes luster to outer districts

IN-PERSON SHOPPING HABITS CHANGED IN BOSTON SINCE 2019

Since pandemic-era store closures, in-person spending has had the biggest comeback in East Boston while neighborhoods in and around downtown haven’t yet bounced back.

SOURCE: City of Boston Planning Department, Research Division. LILY COWPER FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE



In-person consumer spending in 2024 as a percentage of in-person consumer spending in 2019 (adjusted for inflation).

DOWNTOWN, Page A14

Boston group has deal for WNBA team

League balks at moving Sun

By Gary Washburn

GLOBE STAFF

WNBA basketball could be played in Boston permanently by 2027 as a group led by Celtics minority owner Steve Pagliuca has reached a deal to buy the women’s Connecticut Sun basketball team and relocate it to TD Garden, according to multiple sources involved in the transaction.

Pagliuca will pay the Mohe-

gan Tribe a record \$325 million for the team, according to those sources, then contribute \$100 million for a new practice facility in Boston for the Sun to relocate from the tribe’s casino complex in Uncasville, Conn. Sources said the Mohegan Tribe has been looking to sell the club and the record offer expedited the process.

The sale price would be the highest ever for a professional women’s sports franchise.

A Sun source said the Mohegan Tribe has been looking

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From a singular talent, an audacious new reach

By Malcolm Gay

GLOBE STAFF

In 2015, The New York Times crowned composer Matthew Aucoin the “most promising operatic talent in a generation.” He was just 25 years old.

“That is a serious curse to carry with you,” said Peter Sellars, a renowned opera director. “If the Times says you’re the future of American opera, and you’re still alive? That’s a miracle.”

Raised in Medfield, Aucoin has seemingly fulfilled that promise in the ensuing decade, reaching the heights of the opera world as he



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

At 35, Matthew Aucoin has reached the heights of the opera world.

won high-profile commissions, wrote a well-received book, and cofounded a critically acclaimed opera company. In case there was any doubt, the MacArthur Foundation made it official when it named him a fellow, an honor commonly referred to as a “genius” grant.

Now, at 35, Aucoin has produced a singular musical work that is being hailed as revolutionary, an uncategorizable vocal symphony that represents a major departure — not just for Aucoin, but perhaps for operatic music more broadly.

AUCOIN, Page A15



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